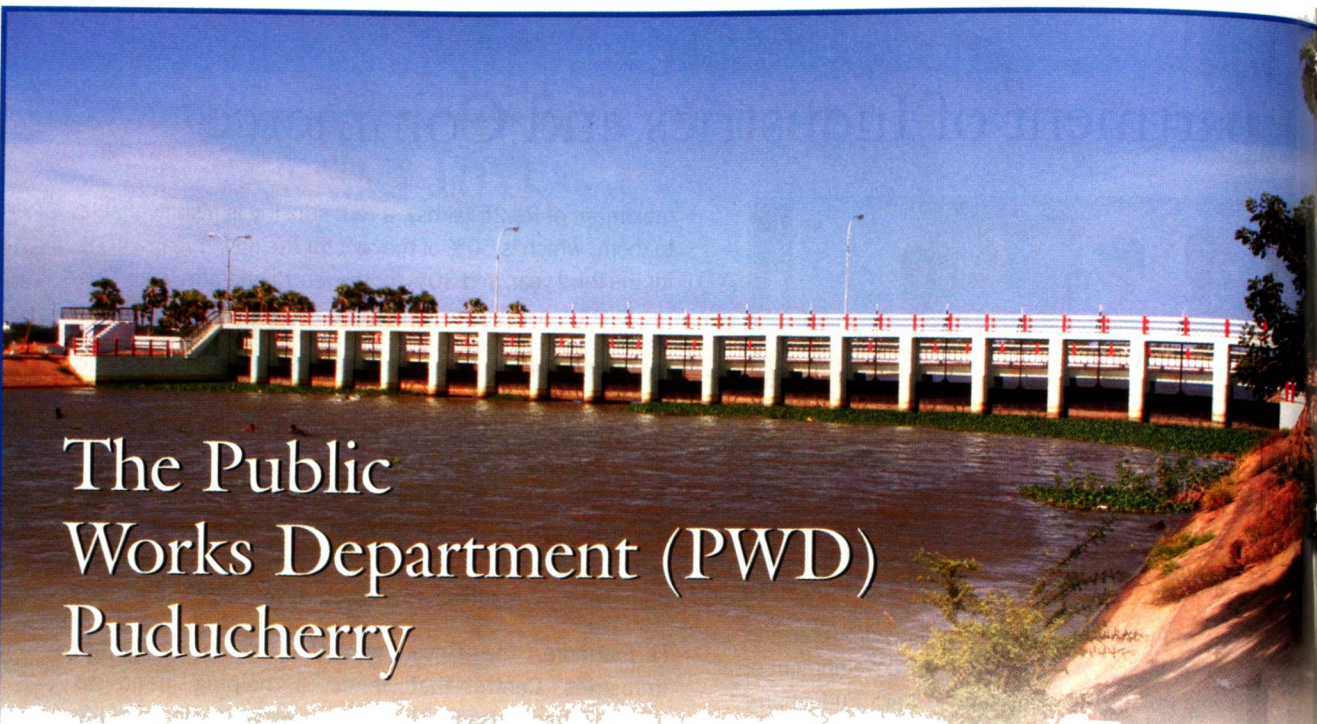




# The Public Works Department (PWD) Puducherry

**W**e are living in very difficult times. While man continues to inflict pain upon himself through his mindless actions, nature too on its part has begun to unfurl a series of horrors on mankind! The result? we have the Tsunami, cyclonic storms, droughts, famine, etc. Though a Government cannot be expected to prevent these natural calamities, it can protect its subjects from harm by taking necessary precautionary measures. This is where the foresightedness of the Puducherry Government and its Public Works Department has helped make a difference!

Puducherry mostly depends upon its ground water resources for irrigation and the supply of drinking water. With the Tsunami causing saline water intrusion in the ground water acquifers, and the failure of monsoons and excessive usage of water causing the rapid depletion of the water resources, the PWD adopted an eco-friendly approach to replenish the diminishing water resources.

Puducherry has four enclaves which are lying in coastal areas having a flat terrain with no near possibility to create any ideal reservoirs. Hence, PWD decided to store the flood water, by constructing bed dams and tail end regulators in all the rivers; this was planned with the sole aim of recharging the ground water acquifers and arresting the

saline water intrusion. The department has constructed bed dams and tail end regulators in Puducherry and Karaikal regions. Besides these fully operational bed dams, a few more have been proposed. A bed dam across the Sankarapani river is being planned at an estimated cost of Rs.15,00,00,000. The PWD is also planning to construct a bed dam at Mullodai tail end, at an estimated cost of Rs.11,60,00,000. Plans are also on to reconstruct a diversion anicut across the Sankaraparani river at Suthukeny, with a two lane bridge connecting Kaikalapet. This ambitious project is estimated at Rs.32,26,00,000. Additionally, there is a plan to build a bridge cum regulator a Kumaramangalam village across Malatar, which is estimated at Rs.7,10,00,000. Also on the cards is the construction of a barrage cum bridge near Thirukanji Kasiviswanathar temple connecting Kombakkam road, at an estimated cost of Rs.15,00,00,000.

In addition to this, the PWD occasionally reminds the people of Puducherry of the gaps in the demand and supply of water, and educates them on how to use the scarce water resources prudently. Moreover, industries have also been advised to explore the possibilities of recycling their waste water, and the target is at least 50%.

